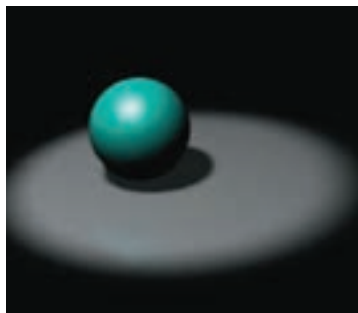


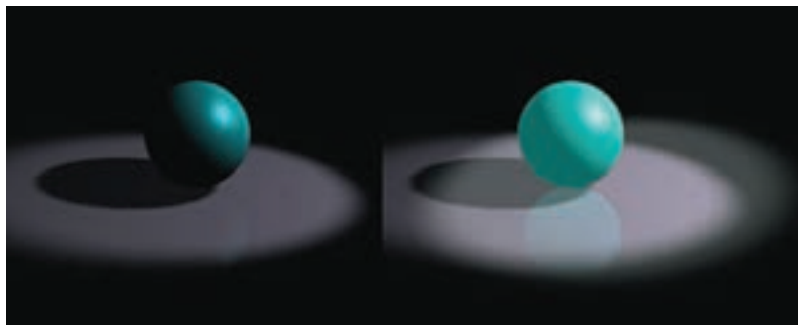
far attenuation. These are much more controllable than just simple decay and allow you to set ranges for the decay of the light when it gets close or far from the source. Attenuation is terrific for putting light into specific places in a scene.

Advanced Lighting Effects

The Advanced Effects rollout contains additional parameters to control the character of a light. Lights can be configured to have more contrast or to soften, as well as to illuminate only ambient, diffuse, or specular parts of the scene. These effects can be handy when lighting a scene, because you can configure a light to add contrast, softness, or ambient lighting to anything it illuminates.



Basic lighting on a sphere contains diffuse and specular lighting.



Effects are best used in conjunction with other lights. In this case, a standard spotlight is used (left) and an ambient-only spotlight is added (right) to brighten up the dark spots on the sphere.

Lights can also be used to project images on parts of the scene, much like a slide projector. This is accomplished by using a map in the Colour channel. This can be anything from a bitmap to a procedural texture, such as a ramp.

Atmospheres and Effects

3ds Max offers several ways to add special effects to lights. These effects can be loaded by using the Atmospheres & Effects rollout in the light's Modify panel. Each light can have multiple effects added, and third-party effects can also be loaded as plug-ins. 3ds Max comes with two ways to affect a light: volume lights and lens effects.